addition, they face extortion and forced labor and serious religious persecution. The destruction of religious sites, including mosques, has been documented. It would be accurate to label the situation regarding the Rohingya as ethnic cleansing.

The army and tatmadaw have been guilty of significant human rights violations in the Muslim areas. Human Rights Watch, Amnesty International, and Doctors without Borders have all documented cases of forced deportation and excessive violence in Rakhine state. Overcrowded camps have been set up to take in the influx of refugees across the border in Bangladesh. Numerous cases of child abduction, rape, forced labor, and kidnapping have been documented by multiple human rights authorities. Medecins Sans Frontieres (Doctors without Borders) claims that violence increased significantly in late 2010. Several doctors treated patients for beatings, machete wounds, and rape. Furthermore, the refugee population was running out of food and drinking water. In addition, the sanitation conditions in the camps have been worsening and subsequently the spread of disease is increasing.

Ethnic tension in Rakhine State was rekindled during June 2012 following a series of events that led to increased sectarian violence. The rape and murder of a Buddhist girl by three Muslim men and the subsequent lynching of nearly a dozen Muslims by a mob of 300 Buddhists initially started the violence. Ultimately, dozens of Rohingyas were killed and hundreds wounded as the violence and tension increased in June. Furthermore, the sectarian violence led to the displacement of more than 30,000 Muslims, and the property loss was in the millions.

Thein Sein called for a State of Emergency in order to quell the violence. The ethnic and religious hostility seems to run high in this region of Myanmar as the Buddhist majority pushes for the forced removal of the Muslim population across the border into Bangladesh. A resolution to this tense situation seems remote.

Resolving the ethnic problem is Myanmar is the single most important issue facing the current government. In many respects, the lack of democratic gains in the modern period and the subsequent militarization of Myanmar stem from the ethnic troubles encountered by earlier regimes. It was the fear of a possible fragmentation that led the authorities to adopt a